

Room layouts and activity zones

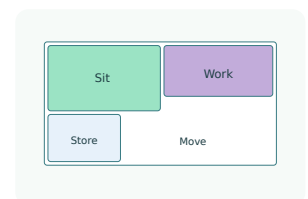
Space planning starts with activities and routes. Define functional zones, then compare layouts without concealing openings, services or access requirements.

What you will accomplish

- Define activities and zones
- Identify relationships between zones
- Check the layout through a use sequence

Define activities and zones

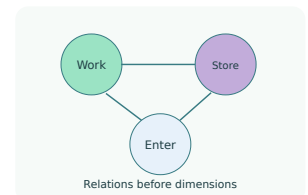
List activities, users, timing and required contents. Sketch an initial zone for each without approving unknown furniture dimensions. A functional zone includes the object, its operation and related movement. Check which activities occur together before developing a final arrangement.



A zone includes the activity, not just the object footprint.

Identify relationships between zones

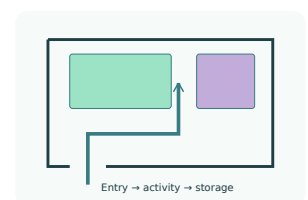
Identify useful adjacencies, such as storage near work or dining near serving, and separations needed for privacy or quiet. An adjacency diagram expresses priorities, not final distances. Test those relationships in the actual plan with openings, services and circulation before approval.



Adjacency priorities must be tested in the measured plan.

Check the layout through a use sequence

Trace entry, access to the activity, storage use and exit. Show doors and moving parts in the intended scenarios. Compare alternatives against the same activities and record routes through another activity or inaccessible storage. After relocating a zone, recheck the complete sequence so the clash is not merely displaced.



Recheck the complete route after moving a zone.

Worked case and decision

One room contains a sitting area and work zone. One layout puts the desk on the entry route; another places it near storage clear of the door. Test both against the same user tasks.

Decision: prefer the arrangement that supports entry and storage access without interrupting the main activity.

Check understanding

What belongs in a functional zone?

- The object footprint alone
- The object, its use and required movement
- The colour alone

Correct: The object, its use and required movement. An object footprint alone can conceal an opening or access clash.

Lesson questions

Should I place all furniture before adding circulation?

Develop activities, furniture and routes together. Leaving circulation until the end can force major layout changes.

Practice

Identify a room's activities, map their relationships and compare two layouts.

Users and activities

Adjacencies and alternatives

Use sequence and selection rationale

Review your work against the criteria. Saving it does not constitute technical project approval.

- Both layouts use the same brief
- Openings and services are visible
- The full use sequence is checked